

Day 5

Here's a practical way to build a strong beginner software engineering resume and use Overleaf LaTeX well: keep it one page, put projects and skills near the top, and use a clean ATS-friendly layout with clear section headers. Overleaf is easy to start with: create a project, pick a resume template, edit the text between `\begin{document}` and `\end{document}`, then click **Recompile** to preview the PDF.

Resume tips for beginners

- Start with a short summary of 1–2 lines that says who you are and what role you want; keep it focused and specific.
- Put **Projects** high on the page if you have limited work experience, because recruiters want proof that you can build things.
- List only technologies you can actually discuss in an interview; don't pad the skills section.
- Use action verbs and outcomes, such as "built," "improved," "reduced," or "automated," instead of vague duties.
- Keep formatting simple: standard fonts, consistent spacing, and no overly decorative design.
- Tailor the resume to each job by matching relevant skills and projects to the role.

Good structure

Use this order for a beginner resume: header, summary, technical skills, projects, education, internships or experience, and certifications if relevant. If you don't have formal software experience yet, projects and coursework can carry the resume as long as they show real technical ability.

A simple project bullet should look like this: "Built a task-tracking web app using React and Node.js; added authentication and reduced manual tracking time for 20

users". That format shows what you made, how, and why it mattered.

Overleaf basics

1. Go to Overleaf and create a new project, ideally from a resume/CV template.
2. Replace placeholder text with your name, links, education, skills, and projects.
3. Write content inside the document body, which is the area between `\begin{document}` and `\end{document}`.
4. Press **Recompile** to see changes immediately in the PDF preview.
5. Use the template's existing structure first, then edit section titles or add new sections once you are comfortable.

Useful LaTeX commands

- `\section{Education}` creates a section heading.
- `\textbf{Project Name}` makes text bold.
- `\begin{itemize} ... \end{itemize}` creates bullet points.
- `\emph{text}` italicizes or emphasizes text depending on context.
- `\href{url}{label}` adds clickable links if the template supports `hyperref`.

Example snippet:

```
tex\section{Projects}
\begin{itemize}
  \item Built a weather dashboard using React and OpenWeather API.
  \item Added search, caching, and responsive UI for mobile users.
\end{itemize}
```

This kind of structure is easy to read and works well in Overleaf.

Common beginner mistakes

- Writing long paragraphs instead of short, scannable bullets.
- Using too many skills that you cannot explain confidently.
- Making the resume more than one page when you are just starting out.
- Using unusual fonts, columns, or heavy graphics that may hurt ATS readability.

- Forgetting to customize the resume for the job description.